



3-9-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hPxKu3P8Vac
Publication Date	2021-03-10T12:19:02Z
Target Category	mcs

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order on March 9th, noting it was a "beautiful spring day almost spring," and opened with an informal mention of a broken-winged eagle left with him to ensure an appropriate burial.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, and Board President Mr. Williams. (Mrs. Bales and Mrs. Barnes Griffin are noted in roll call checks/attendance as called).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted as absent during roll call.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (Board President).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening remarks included recognitions of school staff, student presentations, and a moment of gratitude for community partners.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and routine items were handled via the consent agenda (Items A through G inclusive), which included review and acceptance of

community donations. Approved by Voice Vote.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:10 South View Elementary School Presentation & Staff Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Williams (Principal) accompanied by Mrs. Houston (Assistant Principal), Mrs. Ledbetter (Master Teacher), Miss Morrow (Mentor Teacher), and Ms. Garris (Mentor Teacher).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The South View leadership team presented their academic “glows and grows,” focusing on teacher support, student achievement, the new reading curriculum (interactive F&P slides), the “Read to the Final Four” reading initiative, and social-emotional learning (SEL) programs like the “Zones of Regulation” and Meridian Health Services partnership. The board reviewed preliminary i-Ready student data showing shrinkage across all grade levels in the “red” (two or more grade levels below) performance band.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received for information; praised by the board.
- **00:43:12 High Ability Education District Update & Rebranding Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenny Smith (District High Ability Coordinator), alongside teacher Courtney Williams and parent/marketing representative Cindy Miller.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the district’s high ability (ELP) program structure across elementary and secondary levels, noting that Muncie provides an all-day self-contained model rather than a weekly pull-out program. The board and presenters discussed results from recent parent and teacher surveys, identifying a need to rebrand the program name from “ELP” to something clear like “Muncie High Ability Program” to reduce confusion with English Learner / language programs, and discussed ongoing efforts to improve program diversity and marketing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Cindy Miller (parent and 24-year marketing veteran) spoke on her experience enrolling her son David in the program and advocating for clear program communication.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; consensus support from the board for rebranding and marketing expansion.
- **01:29:58 Summer Learning & Enrichment Opportunities (01:29:58 & 01:40:42)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell and Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented comprehensive plans for summer programming across elementary, middle, and high school levels. Programs include 3rd-grade literacy/i-READ camps, Camp Adventure (science and literacy), youth writing and poetry camps, middle/high school orientation camps (Panther/Titan camps partnering with Project Leadership), high school credit recovery, online academy courses, and in-person Physical Education and marching band. All district-run

programs will be provided **free of charge** to families, entirely offset by local and federal grant funds.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (with subsequent board agreement to hire additional staff if student demand exceeds caps).
- **01:54:39 E-Rate Technology Equipment Bid Award**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer) and Tony Harvey.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented bids opened March 1st for district-wide E-rate network equipment and licenses. The contract for Option 2 equipment totals \$716,209.01, but Muncie Community Schools is only responsible for a **10% local share** (\$71,620.90), with the remaining 90% covered directly by federal E-rate funds paid to the vendor (Network Solutions from Carmel, IN).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:57:51 Architectural Services Amendment: Schmidt Associates (EWA & South View)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (CFO).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed an amendment to the letter of agreement with Schmidt Associates to begin architectural design, planning, and specifications for major facility improvements at East Washington Academy (EWA) and South View Elementary, utilizing Phase 2 federal CARES funds (estimated at approximately \$11.2 million total allocation).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:59:37 Reimbursement Resolution for Future Construction/Bond Projects**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (CFO).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduced by legal counsel (Jane Herndon of Ice Miller) as a best-practice resolution allowing the district to retroactively reimburse itself from future bond issues for capital expenses currently paid out of the existing construction fund (\$900,000 baseline figure). Does not commit the district to selling bonds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:28:28 Beth Cradler** (Muncie Public Library): Announced that starting Monday, March 15th, the public library will reopen for “grab-and-go” visits without required appointments (requested to limit visits to about an hour). She also noted that effective April 5th, operating hours will shift to Monday<U+2013>Friday 1:00 PM <U+2013> 7:00 PM,

Saturday 1:00 PM <U+2013> 5:00 PM, and closed Sundays, while maintaining grab-and-go services.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Superintendent Update (01:27:03):** Dr. Gikowski provided updates on the Promise Neighborhood grant (recognizing the George and Frances Ball Foundation, Tom Kinghorn, Courtney, and Kelsey), ongoing i-READ3 assessments, school visits with Ball State Dean Mari, low COVID-19 classroom case numbers alongside teacher vaccination progress, and upcoming spring registration and virtual learning options for next year.
 - **Board Announcements:** President Williams announced that the university officially approved the board's request to extend the lease and continued use of **Northside Middle School** for several additional years.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and approved by voice vote at **02:08:00**.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-04 09:27:01 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.